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I have been searching for a job for more than a year and I still have not got a job. What are the options that I have?

Don't lose hope. There are examples of candidates who have good jobs and successful careers, who couldn't get any job initially. Continue to search for jobs, but also explore other options in this situation:

1. Go in for higher studies and improve your academic qualifications.
2. If you have a bachelor's degree, consider enrolling for a master's degree such as an MBA, M.Tech, or other courses, depending on your interest.
3. Consider joining advanced courses, such as a post-graduate diploma programme from C-DAC.
4. Do some certification courses in your areas of interest, which can improve your chances of getting a good job.
5. Join some evergreen job-oriented courses such as software testing and technical writing.
6. Depending on your interest, take some specialised courses such as advanced animation, or CAD-CAM, from established institutes like Aptech, NIIT, etc.
7. Learn any new computer skills: new programming languages like C, C++, Java, operating systems (Unix, Linux), applications (Tally, etc). Such job skills significantly increase your chances of getting a job.
8. Network with your college seniors, relatives or friends who are already working and ask them to forward your resume to their HR departments.
9. Send your CV to companies both directly and through consultants.
10. Improve soft skills: communication skills, presentation skills, learning foreign languages (Japanese, French, German, etc).
11. Do software projects: it adds value to your CV. Try doing a project from a reputed organisation (MNCs, PSUs, government organisations, etc). Don't pay for doing projects. Rather, try working as a trainee without getting paid or with a minimum stipend (to gain experience).

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Is it necessary to change jobs frequently to get a better pay and position?

No, it is not a good idea to change jobs frequently. Try to stick to a company and work there for at least 3 to 5 years.

There are good reasons why one would change a job for professional reasons (better pay, career advancement, new work environment, new area of work, overseas work assignments, etc), or personal reasons (getting married, want to live with parents, etc). It is perfectly acceptable to change a job for such reasons. However, don't change your job frequently. There are many reasons why we should avoid 'job hopping'.

Potential employers look at the job history of candidates before selecting them. If a person has changed jobs often (say, 5 jobs in 5 years!), it is very likely that the person will do so in future as well, so employers prefer not recruiting such candidates. Typically, it requires around 6 months to become productive in a new organisation and start contributing. If you leave the job within a short period—say within a year—it is a loss to the company because of many reasons: the company has ramped you in your new job and that effort is lost, the company has to spend again to recruit a new person for your position, the work gets pending till the time the new person on board becomes productive, etc. So it becomes difficult to get a new job if you are a 'job hopper'.

It is better to take a long-term view about your career. It takes at least 5 years to learn enough about the job, the company, the technology, become highly productive, and make significant contributions to the company. The pay and position we get in the company depends on the level of contribution we make to the company. If you find 'your kind of job and company' and stick to it, and focus on contributing to the company, you'll naturally grow and earn better than if you keep shifting jobs. 'Focus on learning than earning'—that's what all the successful people have done!

Some FAQ to candidates and how to answer them

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Tell me about yourself.

This is an open-ended question that interviewers ask at the beginning of the interview to know more about you. They also use this question to get an idea of how you look at yourself and your achievements.

Briefly explain your professional background, the projects you've done, significant contributions you've made in your previous jobs, and conclude with a note about your personal background and a few points on your positive personal characteristics. Don't talk for an hour; make it short and to-the-point. Also, don't overemphasise your personal details.